

QUESTION 21

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The Fig Tree Ledger is a 2019 novel by Nadia Farouk. The narrator describes the shopkeeper, Mr. Bassam, as someone who assists his neighbors without ever letting them learn that the help came from him: _____. Which quotation from The Fig Tree Ledger most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'At the school ceremony each spring, Mr. Bassam was called to the stage and thanked by name for the scholarship fund he had established a decade earlier.'

B: 'When the widow's rent came due, an envelope appeared beneath her door with no name written on it; Bassam denied knowing anything about it, though the handwriting matched the labels on his shop's shelves.'

C: 'Bassam kept a ledger of every neighbor who owed him money and quietly forgave the debt whenever he judged that a family had suffered enough.'

D: 'Every Saturday Bassam volunteered at the community kitchen, ladling soup and greeting each visitor who came through the line by name.'

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim requires the recipient NOT to know who helped. B has an unsigned envelope and a denial -- the aid is untraceable to him except by the reader. A is public credit at a ceremony. C is generous but the debtor knows exactly who forgave the debt. D is visible service where he is seen and known.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 22

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Ninth Street Winter is a 2021 novel by Grace Oyelaran. The narrator portrays her mother as someone who assessed a person's character by observing how that person treated people who could offer nothing in return: _____. Which quotation from Ninth Street Winter most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'My mother refused to socialize with anyone who had more money than she did, convinced that wealth spoiled a person long before they noticed it themselves.'

B: 'My mother said a person's true nature surfaced only in anger, and at any gathering she waited for the first raised voice the way a birdwatcher waits at dawn.'

C: 'My mother trusted only those she had known for decades, insisting that no one's character could be measured across a single evening.'

D: 'My mother paid no attention to how a guest spoke to her. She watched how he spoke to the boy clearing the plates, and said that was the whole man.'

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: match the specific yardstick in the claim -- treatment of those who can give nothing back. D contrasts the host (worth impressing) with the plate-clearing boy (nothing to offer). A judges by wealth, B by temper, C by length of acquaintance -- three different yardsticks.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 23

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The Second Apprentice is a 2018 novel by Marek Dvorak. The narrator describes the clockmaker Tobias as someone who mastered his craft entirely through observation, without instruction of any kind: _____. Which quotation from The Second Apprentice most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'No one had ever shown Tobias how to set an escapement. He had stood at the shop window through three winters watching the old man's hands move behind the glass, until his own fingers knew the motion without being told.'

B: 'Tobias completed a four-year apprenticeship under the finest clockmaker in the province before opening his own shop on the far side of the square.'

C: 'Tobias read every volume on horology the town library held, teaching himself from folded diagrams and columns of written instruction.'

D: 'Tobias possessed a natural feel for mechanism that his teachers recognized in his first year and spent the next several cultivating.'

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim names one method (observation) and rules out one thing (instruction). A gives both: watching hands through glass, and 'no one had ever shown him.' B is formal instruction. C is self-taught but from written instruction, not observation. D credits innate talent plus teachers.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 24

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Low Country Almanac is a 2020 novel by Harriet Boone. The narrator presents Aunt Ruby as someone who turns attention away from her accomplishments by describing them as ordinary: _____ Which quotation from Low Country Almanac most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Ruby never mentioned the medal to anyone, and the family learned of it only after her death, when it turned up in a drawer beneath a stack of unpaid receipts.'

B: 'Ruby maintained that she had been lucky rather than skilled, and she believed it privately as well, having never thought much of her own abilities.'

C: 'When the paper called Ruby a hero for pulling two children out of the surf, she said she had happened to be standing closest to the water, and that any fool would have gotten wet.'

D: 'Ruby changed the subject whenever her work came up, steering the conversation toward whoever else happened to be sitting in the room.'

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: understatement means she acknowledges the deed but shrinks it. C accepts the rescue happened, then reframes it as proximity plus common sense. A hides the achievement entirely -- no downplaying, just silence. B is sincere low self-regard, not deflection. D deflects by redirecting attention, never describing the deed at all.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 25

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The Weaver's Hour is a 2022 novel by Ines Duarte. The narrator describes her grandmother, whose memory has faded, as someone whose hands still perform work her mind can no longer recall: _____ Which quotation from The Weaver's Hour most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Grandmother spoke constantly of the mill where she had worked as a girl, recounting the same three stories in the same order every afternoon.'

B: 'Grandmother could not say what year it was or name the month, but seated at the loom she threw the shuttle in a rhythm no one had taught her in sixty years, and the pattern came out without a single error.'

C: 'Grandmother kept her old loom in the corner of the room and asked every visitor to admire it, though she no longer had the strength to work it.'

D: 'Grandmother's doctors remarked on how sharp she had remained, attributing her clarity to a lifetime of demanding manual work.'

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim needs a split -- mind failing, hands succeeding. B has both halves: cannot name the year, yet weaves flawlessly. A shows verbal memory working, not failing. C is attachment to an object, with no work performed. D denies the memory loss the claim depends on.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 26

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Cold Spring Landing is a 2017 novel by Peter Halvorsen. The narrator portrays the village as a place where privacy is impossible: _____ Which quotation from Cold Spring Landing most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Villagers greeted one another by name on the street and rarely passed without stopping to trade a few words about the weather or the ferry schedule.'

B: 'The village had one road in and one road out, so any car that arrived was noticed by somebody before it reached the square.'

C: 'Villagers were quick to take in newcomers, and a family that arrived on Monday could expect a supper invitation before the week was out.'

D: 'By the time Ana returned from the clinic in the next county, three neighbors had already left soup on her step. She had told no one she was ill.'

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: no privacy means personal information travels without being shared. D nails it -- she told nobody, yet everybody knew. A and C show sociability and hospitality, which are pleasant, not invasive. B shows arriving strangers being noticed, which is surveillance of outsiders, not exposure of a resident's private life.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 27

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The Card Room is a 2019 novel by Yusra Halabi. The narrator suggests that Selim grasps what people want before they have said it: _____ Which quotation from The Card Room most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Selim had already poured the second cup and pushed it across the table before his visitor finished explaining that he could not stay long. The man drank it and stayed two hours.'

B: 'Selim was an attentive listener who never interrupted, and his friends often remarked that an hour in his company left them feeling understood.'

C: 'Selim studied faces the way other men studied newspapers, and could name the province a stranger came from by the shape of his vowels.'

D: 'Selim rarely offered an opinion until everyone else had spoken, a habit that made him appear wiser than he privately believed himself to be.'

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: 'before they have said it' demands action that precedes the words. A shows the cup poured before the sentence ends, and the visitor's real wish proven by his staying. B is skilled listening -- after the words. C deduces where someone is from, not what they want. D is restraint in speaking, not insight into others.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 28

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: House of Thirty Doors is a 2021 novel by Leila Marash. The narrator presents Mrs. Farid as someone for whom hosting is a duty discharged rather than a pleasure taken: _____ Which quotation from House of Thirty Doors most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Mrs. Farid complained bitterly about her guests once they had gone, though while they sat at her table she was the very picture of delight.'

B: 'Mrs. Farid opened her home to anyone who knocked, and her kitchen was never quiet for longer than an hour at a stretch.'

C: 'Mrs. Farid laid the table for guests she had not invited and did not like, counting the plates twice, because the counting was required of her and the liking was not.'

D: 'Mrs. Farid had learned hospitality at her mother's side and kept the practice up out of respect for the woman's memory.'

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim separates the act (performed) from the feeling (absent). C states the obligation and the missing warmth in the same breath: counting required, liking not. A shows warmth performed and resentment hidden -- a different split. B measures how much she hosts, not how she feels. D gives a motive (honoring her mother) that is compatible with genuine warmth.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 29

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The Salt Flats is a 2018 novel by Corin Whitfield. The narrator suggests that the residents of the basin have come to resemble the harsh land they live on: _____ Which quotation from The Salt Flats most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'The basin people spoke of the land constantly, describing its moods as though it were a neighbor with a temper and a long memory.'

B: 'Those who could not endure the basin left inside a year, and the ones who stayed had chosen it with their eyes open.'

C: 'The basin soil yielded little, and most families made up the difference with seasonal work in the town forty miles east.'

D: 'They were sparing with water and with speech alike, and a man who used three words where one would serve was regarded in the basin the way a leaking pipe was regarded.'

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: resemblance means a trait of the land shows up in the people. D maps scarcity onto speech -- they ration words as the basin rations water. A personifies the land, the reverse direction. B explains who remains (self-selection), not how the place changed them. C is economic hardship with no trait transferred.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 30

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Two Rivers is a 2020 novel by Amrit Sekhon. The narrator portrays Jaspreet as someone who declines to treat her two homelands as a choice she must make: _____ Which quotation from Two Rivers most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Jaspreet spoke of the country she had left as home, and of the country she lived in as a place she was merely passing through.'

B: 'Asked at the interview which country she considered herself a citizen of, Jaspreet said the question assumed a person could be divided, and that she had never met anyone who was.'

C: 'Jaspreet had grown so accustomed to her adopted country that visits to her birthplace left her feeling like a guest in rooms she had once known by touch.'

D: 'Jaspreet avoided the subject of her origins with colleagues, finding the questions repetitive and the answers never quite worth the effort.'

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: 'declines to treat it as a choice' means rejecting the premise, not picking a side. B rejects the question itself. A picks the birthplace, C drifts toward the adopted country -- both are choices. D dodges the conversation, which is avoidance rather than a stance.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 31

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The Ferryman's Daughter is a 2016 novel by Orla Deane. The narrator suggests that Padraig keeps the old rituals not because he believes in them but because the possibility of being wrong is not worth the risk: _____ Which quotation from The Ferryman's Daughter most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Padraig did not think the coin beneath the mast held any power whatever. But a coin was a small thing and a drowned crew was not, so he set one there each spring and said nothing about it to anyone.'

B: 'Padraig had inherited his father's faith in the old customs and observed them with the seriousness of a man who had watched them work.'

C: 'Padraig mocked the fishermen who painted eyes on their bows, calling them grown children frightened of the dark.'

D: 'Padraig set a coin beneath the mast because his crew expected it of him, and a captain who broke with custom would find their confidence harder to keep.'

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim gives a precise motive -- no belief, plus a hedge against being wrong. A supplies both: he thinks it powerless, yet weighs a coin against a drowned crew. B is sincere belief. C is outright rejection. D is the closest trap, but his motive there is managing the crew, not insuring against his own error.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 32

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The Long Bench is a 2019 novel by Tomasz Reiner. The narrator describes the master carpenter as someone who lets a student fail even when he can see the failure coming: _____ Which quotation from The Long Bench most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'The master corrected each student the instant a mistake appeared, holding that an error repeated twice became an error kept for life.'

B: 'The master demonstrated every technique twice and then watched in silence as the students copied him, offering a word of praise when the work came out clean.'

C: 'The master saw the joint would split before the boy had finished the cut, and said nothing. When it split, he handed the boy a fresh board and still said nothing.'

D: 'The master assigned tasks well beyond his students' ability, believing that struggle was the only teacher whose lessons stayed learned.'

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim requires foresight plus deliberate silence. C has him predicting the split and withholding the warning twice over. A is the opposite -- immediate correction. B is silent observation, but nothing fails. D creates failure through difficulty, not through withholding a correction he could have given.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 33

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: *Weather for Leaving* is a 2022 novel by Dov Perlman. The narrator suggests that Miriam's refusal to travel, which she defends as a matter of principle, is rooted in a fear she will not name: _____. Which quotation from *Weather for Leaving* most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Miriam had a frank and thoroughly acknowledged fear of flying, which she described in detail to anyone who asked and to a few who did not.'

B: 'Miriam explained that travel was money better spent at home, and she said it the same way each time, in the same order, the way a person recites a thing rather than thinks it.'

C: 'Miriam had traveled widely in her twenties and had simply found, in the end, that she preferred her own street to any other.'

D: 'Miriam disapproved of the expense and disruption of tourism, and said so plainly whenever a friend spent savings on a holiday.'

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim needs a stated principle AND a hint that it is a cover. B gives the principle and then undercuts it -- recited identically each time, not thought through. A names the fear openly, so nothing is concealed. C is a genuine preference formed by experience. D presents the principle with no crack in it.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 34

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The Blue Study is a 2021 novel by Vera Lindqvist. The narrator suggests that the painter values a work more while it remains unfinished than after it is complete: _____ Which quotation from The Blue Study most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'The painter worked slowly, returning to the same canvas across several years before she would consent to call it finished.'

B: 'The painter destroyed any work that fell short of her standard, keeping only the few pieces she judged to have met it.'

C: 'The painter left a dozen canvases unfinished at her death, and critics have argued ever since about how she meant to complete them.'

D: 'The painter said the last brushstroke was a small funeral. While a canvas was unfinished it could still become anything; afterward it could only become old.'

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim compares two states and prefers the earlier one. D does exactly that -- unfinished means open possibility, finished means decline. A is slow work aimed at finishing. B is perfectionism about finished pieces. C explains why works were left incomplete (she died), which is circumstance, not preference.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 35

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: *Marram* is a 2018 novel by Fiona Keir. The narrator portrays Ewan as someone whose attachment is to the island itself rather than to the people who live on it: _____. Which quotation from *Marram* most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'When the last of his family sailed for the mainland, Ewan carried their bags down to the pier, waved until the boat rounded the point, and walked back up to a house he had no intention of leaving.'

B: 'Ewan had quarreled with nearly everyone on the island over the years and stayed on chiefly because there was nowhere else that would have him.'

C: 'Ewan spoke of the island's history with real feeling and could name every family that had farmed each field for two centuries back.'

D: 'Ewan believed the island's community was the last of its kind, and what he feared was not the emptying of the land but the scattering of its people.'

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim needs the two loyalties tested against each other. A does it -- people leave, he stays; his family goes, the island keeps him. B makes staying an absence of options, not attachment. C shows attachment to the island's people through its history. D puts the people above the land, reversing the claim.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 36

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The Copy Desk is a 2020 novel by Nnamdi Ofori. The narrator suggests that the editor's insistence on precise wording grows out of concern for people rather than devotion to rules: _____ Which quotation from The Copy Desk most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'The editor kept a marked copy of the style guide at his elbow and could cite the page number for any rule he chose to enforce.'

B: 'The editor was gentle in his corrections, cushioning each note with a word of praise so that no writer left his desk feeling diminished.'

C: 'The editor changed "the patient expired" to "the patient died," and when the young reporter protested that the first was more delicate, he said the family would read this in the morning and delicacy was not what they would need from it.'

D: 'The editor held that sloppy language produced sloppy thinking, and told his staff that a careless sentence was the visible end of a careless mind.'

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim is about WHY he corrects, not how kindly. C gives the reason outright -- the grieving family who will read it. B is the sharpest trap: it shows care in his manner, but his motive is never stated. A is devotion to the rulebook. D cares about thinking, not about people.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 37

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The Boundary Stone is a 2019 novel by Ilias Petrou. The narrator suggests that the feud between the two families continues although no one now living remembers what began it: _____ Which quotation from The Boundary Stone most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'The two families had quarreled over a disputed water right for three generations, and either side could recite the terms of the original agreement from memory.'

B: 'The younger members of both households had grown quietly friendly and regarded the feud as an embarrassment their parents refused to set down.'

C: 'The trouble had started with an insult delivered at a wedding, and every child in both houses could name the guest who delivered it.'

D: 'Asked why the two families did not speak, the old woman said her mother had not spoken to them either, and that her mother's reason had gone into the ground with her.'

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim has two halves -- the feud persists, and the cause is lost. D delivers both: still not speaking, and the reason buried with the previous generation. A and C both preserve the origin in detail, which contradicts the claim. B shows a generational rift about the feud but says nothing about a forgotten cause.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 38

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Ration Book Sundays is a 2017 novel by Colm Beirne. The narrator presents his father's generosity as costly rather than convenient, given out of what the family could not spare: _____ Which quotation from Ration Book Sundays most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'My father gave to the parish collection every week without fail, and the sum was never a small one.'

B: 'My father handed the coal money to the family next door in November and told his own children that a bit of cold was good for them, which was the only lie I ever heard him tell.'

C: 'My father lent his tools to anyone on the road who asked and never once pressed a man for their return.'

D: 'My father gave the proceeds of a good harvest to the school roof fund, holding back only what the family would need to see out the winter.'

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: cost means the giver goes without. B has his own children cold and a lie told to cover it -- the price is visible. D is the trap: a large gift, but he keeps what the family needs, so nothing is sacrificed. A shows amount and regularity without showing what it cost him. C is lending, which returns the item.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 39

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The Ash Cloud Diaries is a 2022 novel by Rowan Beckett. The narrator suggests that the volcanologist's willingness to take risks springs from curiosity rather than from any appetite for danger: _____ Which quotation from The Ash Cloud Diaries most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'She had climbed more active craters than anyone else in the field and kept a running tally of them in the back pages of her notebook.'

B: 'She dismissed the safety protocols as excessive, maintaining that fifteen years of experience was a better guide than any checklist written by a committee.'

C: 'She was afraid on the ridge and said so aloud. Then the plume changed color, and she went closer, because she had never seen that color before and could not hold another thought in her head.'

D: 'She accepted the hazards of her work as the ordinary cost of a career she had chosen, no different in kind from a miner's or a deep-sea fisherman's.'

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: curiosity, not appetite for danger, means fear is present and wonder overrides it. C shows the fear admitted and then displaced by a new observation. A keeps score of dangers survived -- that is appetite. B is contempt for caution. D treats risk as an occupational given, with no curiosity driving it.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 40

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The Understudy's Notebook is a 2021 novel by Priya Raghunathan. The narrator suggests that the conductor's public assurance conceals a private doubt he never shows the orchestra: _____. Which quotation from The Understudy's Notebook most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'He walked to the podium without a score, raised his hands, and held the orchestra a full four seconds before the downbeat. In the interval he had been sick in the washroom, and he came back with his collar damp.'

B: 'He spoke openly of his doubts to anyone who asked, and the orchestra found the admission endearing rather than alarming.'

C: 'He was demanding in rehearsal and quick to stop the players, a severity they put down to nerves rather than to standards.'

D: 'He had been certain of himself as a young man and had lost that certainty by degrees across twenty years at the podium.'

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: concealment requires both faces in the same quotation. A gives the public one (no score, commanding pause) and the hidden one (sick, damp collar). B removes the concealment by making the doubt public. C is the players guessing at nerves, not the conductor's inner state. D traces a change over time rather than a gap between surface and interior.

END QUESTION